

BIHAR FLOOD RELIEF FUND

KOSI FLOODS 2008

A New SHELTER



CARE TODAY is helping the Kosi flood victims build disaster-resistant houses



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**SHIVNARAYAN
MANDAL,
PRADEEP MANDAL
AND THEIR
FAMILIES WILL
SOON MOVE
INTO THEIR
NEW HOMES**

Immediately after the Kosi river breached its embankments on August 18, 2008, rendering millions homeless, CARE TODAY initiated the Bihar Flood Relief Fund to help and rehabilitate the flood-affected communities. Our appeal met with a generous response from across the country and we raised Rs 1.43 crore by August 31, 2009. Responding to the urgent needs of the people, CARE TODAY, in September 2008 itself started work in the villages of Nawgachhia subdivision of Bhagalpur district through an NGO, the Bihar Development Trust, with a grant of Rs 5 lakh.

Besides rushing to meet the urgent needs of the people, we also launched two simultaneous efforts for the long-term rehabilitation of the poorest households. We are currently supporting 150 children and their families in Jorgama village of Madhepura district for a period of two years with a grant of Rs 25.20 lakh to the sos Children's Villages of India. The second project in Supaul district supports another NGO, Kutch Nav Nirman Abhiyan (KNNA), also called Abhiyan, to reconstruct the houses in a hamlet (Mandal Mehta Tola) in Puraini village, which bore the brunt as the Kosi changed course. Almost all the 89 households in Tola are poor and were impacted deeply due to the subsequent flooding, strong winds and soil erosion. Being built under the Owner-Driven Reconstruction (ODR) plan, there is complete partici-

pation of the house owners in building their houses.

Based in Bhuj, Gujarat, the KNNA has been advocating good practices to influence the Government over the rehabilitation of affected communities. It constructed four prototype houses at the district magistrate's office in Saharsa where people from the Puraini village were taken for an exposure-cum-orientation visit. They studied the prototypes for the use of construction materials, technology and also the earthquake, flood and cyclone-resistant features. Begun in April 2009, most of the houses had been constructed till their roof levels by September 7, 2009. A socio-technical team of the KNNA, based close to the Puraini village, uses practical and innovative solutions to address construction-related issues. CARE TODAY is supporting this owner-driven, disaster-resistant housing reconstruction project with a grant of Rs 59.51 lakh to KNNA and all the 89 houses will be completed in October 2009.

CARE TODAY was set up by the INDIA TODAY Group in 1999 to channelise financial contributions from readers for helping the victims of calamities. Its varied projects over the last decade have rekindled hope amongst people and communities across the country. CARE TODAY has made a difference to the lives of the disabled soldiers of the Kargil War and people affected by the natural disasters in Orissa, Gujarat, Jammu and Kashmir, Tamil Nadu and now Bihar.